

R Matthews, CSM, PMP

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Delivery Manager and Certified Scrum Master who drives predictable, effective delivery by combining people-centered leadership with data-informed decision making. Bridges business goals and technical execution to create clarity, remove obstacles, and enable high-performing teams. Leads with empathy and accountability to deliver sustainable results.

CORE VALUE OFFERING

- Agile delivery expert skilled in facilitating Scrum ceremonies, managing backlogs, and optimizing team velocity while maintaining sustainable pace and quality standards.
- Cross-functional team leader who creates psychological safety, fosters collaboration, and removes impediments to enable teams to consistently deliver value.
- Stakeholder management specialist adept at translating business needs into actionable work, facilitating alignment across product and engineering, and managing expectations through transparent communication.
- Data-driven process optimizer who leverages delivery metrics, team feedback, and retrospective insights to identify bottlenecks, reduce waste, and continuously improve delivery effectiveness.
- Risk and dependency manager who proactively identifies potential blockers, coordinates across teams, and ensures smooth delivery through anticipation and mitigation of challenges.
- Technical background (software engineering) enabling credible collaboration with development teams, realistic estimation support, and informed facilitation of technical discussions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MOODY'S RATINGS, Charlotte, NC

2019 – Present

Delivery Manager | Technical Product Lead, April 2023 - Present

- Lead two cross-functional Agile teams (15+ engineers, QA, designers) delivering a KYC/AML customer screening web application supporting critical commercial onboarding workflows with predictable velocity and high quality.
- Facilitate all Scrum ceremonies including daily standups, sprint planning, backlog refinement, sprint reviews, and retrospectives, ensuring productive meetings that drive team alignment and continuous improvement.
- Drive delivery planning and execution by partnering with product owners on roadmap prioritization, facilitating estimation sessions, managing sprint capacity, and tracking progress against commitments.
- Create clarity across product and engineering by translating business requirements into actionable work, maintaining well-groomed backlogs, and ensuring shared understanding of acceptance criteria and definition of done.
- Remove delivery friction and manage impediments by proactively identifying blockers, coordinating dependencies across teams, escalating risks appropriately, and ensuring teams have what they need to execute effectively.
- Leverage delivery metrics and team feedback to optimize processes, identify improvement opportunities, and maintain sustainable delivery pace while balancing business objectives with team capacity.
- Manage stakeholder communications and expectations by providing transparent progress updates, facilitating demos, and partnering closely with product and business leaders on prioritization decisions.
- Contribute beyond core delivery through university recruiting, serving on technology panels, and mentoring early-career professionals in the Moody's Technology Rotation Program.

Software Engineer, August 2021 – March 2023

- Built and enhanced full-stack features for a PDF extraction platform using Angular and Java, supporting document processing and downstream workflows while maintaining code quality and test coverage.
- Actively participated in Agile ceremonies including sprint planning, daily standups, and retrospectives, contributing to story estimation, technical discussions, and continuous improvement initiatives.
- Collaborated with QA, product, and business teams to clarify requirements, support testing efforts, and ensure high-quality, reliable releases that met acceptance criteria.
- Supported team efficiency by proactively identifying technical debt, suggesting process improvements, and mentoring junior developers on coding standards and best practices.

Associate Software Engineer | Moody's Technology Rotation Program, August 2019 – July 2021

- Delivered a custom React-based design library adopted across multiple products, improving UI consistency and development efficiency across engineering teams.

- Supported release readiness by assisting with QA efforts and resolving front-end defects on Moodys.com, ensuring quality user experiences across web properties.
- Demonstrated early leadership by leading cohort meetings and organizing events that fostered inclusion, collaboration, and knowledge sharing across technology rotation program participants.

EDUCATION

BRANDEIS UNIVERSITY, Waltham, MA

2019 – Present

Bachelor of Science | Computer Science & African and African-American Studies

Posse Foundation Full-Tuition Leadership Scholarship (2015-2019)

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Delivery & Agile Leadership: Scrum Facilitation, Agile Delivery, Sprint Planning & Execution, Backlog Management & Refinement, Cross-Functional Team Leadership, Stakeholder Management, Delivery Planning & Forecasting, Risk & Dependency Management, Continuous Improvement & Retrospectives

Data & Tools: Jira, Confluence, Delivery Metrics & Reporting (Velocity, Burndown, Cycle Time), Sprint Planning & Estimation, Team Performance Analytics

Technical Foundations: Full-Stack Development (Java, Angular, React, JavaScript, HTML, CSS), Git, Technical Estimation & Scoping

Certifications: Certified ScrumMaster (CSM - ID: 1589154), Project Management Professional (PMP)

LEADERSHIP & RECOGNITION

- Brandeis University 68th Commencement, **Class Speaker** (May 2019)
- TEDxBrandeisUniversity, **Speaker** (April 2019)
- Hult Prize, **Regional Finalist** (April 2019)
- NSF I-Corps Program, **Finalist** (November 2019)
- AVIOS 2017-2018 Student Speech Application Contest for DocFinder, **Winner** (voice-interactive patient-provider matching web application)